

Kamal Joshi

Lead Software Engineer, Backend | Go | Distributed Systems | AWS | Cloud-Native Platforms

Austin, TX | Remote

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead backend engineer with deep experience designing, building, and operating scalable distributed systems and cloud-native microservices that enterprise teams depend on. Proven track record of improving reliability and reducing operational friction — the same outcomes Cortex delivers to its customers. Bring end-to-end ownership from architecture through production incident response, with a strong instinct for developer experience and platform quality. Fluent in AI-assisted engineering: I use GitHub Copilot and Claude Code daily to produce safe, testable, maintainable code while owning design, quality, and business outcomes.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Backend systems and microservices:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, JSON/HTTP APIs, event-driven systems, distributed systems
- **Scalability and reliability:** highly available services, multi-region deployments, DLQ recovery, rate-limit governance, performance optimization, incident response
- **Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS (ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- **Data storage:** DynamoDB, Oracle/SQL, relational and nonrelational databases
- **Engineering quality:** code reviews, mentoring early-in-career engineers, testable code, deployment validation, operational excellence
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** daily use of GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, and Codex across implementation, testing, debugging, and code review; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Designed, built, and operated scalable backend services including **API Gateway**, **Authorization Service**, and **Third-Party Integrations Service** for Cisco Secure Access, serving enterprise customers with strict reliability requirements.
- **Improved operational reliability** during a production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and redriving messages within **5-10 minutes** — full incident ownership from detection to resolution.
- Led design and delivery of a **real-time event delivery** capability, delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers, enabling customers to integrate security event streams into their own tooling.
- Drove integrations-svc production readiness across **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged changes, validating **HA behavior across two regions**.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key auth and rate-limit behavior, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- **Diagnosed and fixed a critical integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation**, contributing directly to the **customer's purchase decision**.
- Drove cross-service design across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications teams — improving platform consistency and reducing operational burden for downstream teams.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Advanced platform capabilities across API gateway, authorization, integrations, and event-delivery domains, growing into full production ownership.
- Built auth-tools, an internal **authorization library** adopted across multiple platform services, reducing developer friction for downstream teams.
- Integrated **AI tooling (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Codex)** into daily engineering workflow; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design feedback, and hands-on guidance.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for a cloud-native data ingestion platform.
- Built OIDC/OAuth 2.0 authentication flows; optimized query performance for large-scale IP address lookups.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Oracle, Cognizant, Collabera, and others | January 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services and integrations in Java across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and enterprise domains.
- Built foundation in Java, REST APIs, Oracle/SQL, distributed systems patterns, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University